Netherbloom

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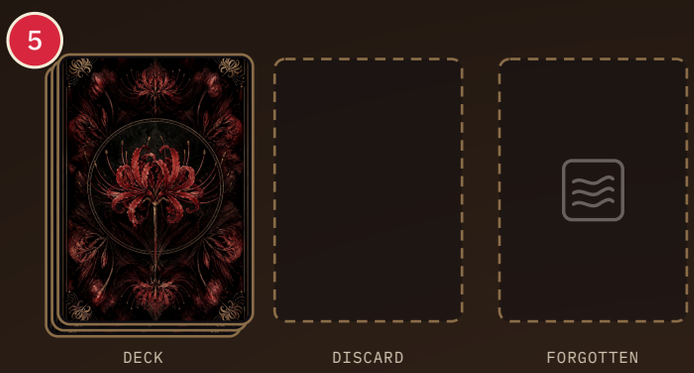
Rulebook

1–4 PLAYERS · 45–60 MIN · 14+

Setting up

The table set for the Child of the Last Flame with three Ferrymen. The numbers match the steps in section 5.



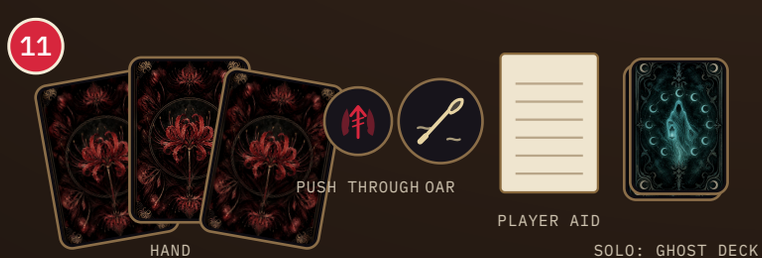
6 **Mist decks** One per Reach, face down beside it: its 10 Mist cards, Rising Water and Shade Drawn Near, and harsh Mist cards by Lantern (0 / 2 / 3 / 3).

5 **Memory deck** 32 core cards and the Soul's own 8 (the 8 Echo cards for the Open Crossing), shuffled, face down. Discard pile face up; the forgotten pile goes on the Ledger.

1 **River board** Three panels, joined edge to edge: Reach I on the left (the near shore, space 0) to Reach III on the right (the Far Shore, space 12).

3 **First Blooms and the soul** A Bloom on both banks of space 1, so the first step is Lit. The soul token starts on the near shore, space 0.

7 **Loom of the Fates** The Loom board, knot discs beside it. Each knot goes on its thread's next circle: a thread snaps at 4 knots with 2–3 players, at 5 in solo or with 4. The Echo token waits beside the board.

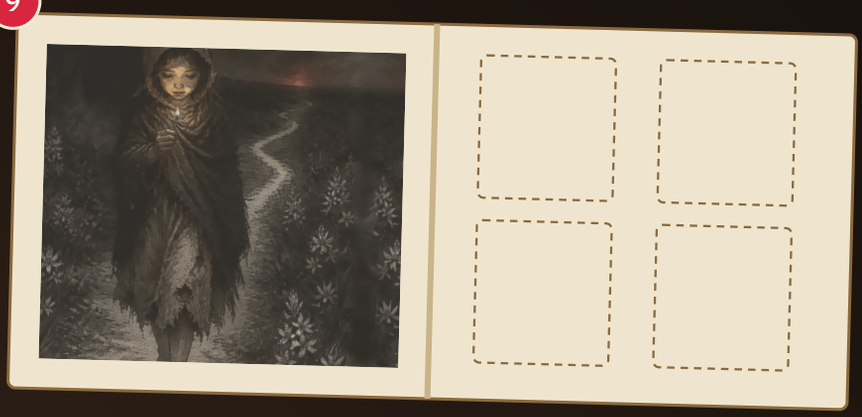


11 **Ferrymen** Deal 3 cards each (4 in solo play). Each player takes a Push Through token face up and a Player Aid. The first player takes the Oar. Solo: the 12 Ghost cards are the Ghost's deck.

4

FRACTURES 3 LIGHT

9



4 Soul card and Lantern The chosen Soul card, face up. Fractures go on the Ledger: the third shatters the soul. The Child starts with 3 Light, the Bride with 1. The Lantern is the difficulty you choose (section 10); it has no piece.

9 Book of Remembrance The chosen Soul's Book, open at Chapter I. Inscribed cards go in its wells, held by the photo corners.

REACH III

FAR SHORE

7 8 9 10 11

2 Bank cards 6 / 8 / 6 cards for Reaches I / II / III. Shuffle each Reach's cards apart and lay them fog side up in the wells of spaces 2–4, 5–8 and 9–11.

8

8 Mantles The 4 Mantle cards, face up, where everyone can reach them.

10

ROOT / BLOOM × 24	SHADE × 8	BLACK WATER × 6
LIGHT × 12	FRACTURE × 3	KNOT × 15
HOLD FAST × 1	SHIELD × 1	RESIGNATION × 1

10 Ledger and supply The Ledger beside the Loom; every token within reach. Black Water: put only the Lantern's number (6 / 5 / 4 / 3 for Gentle / Standard / Hard / Heroic) in the Ledger's Black Water well and the rest back in the box.

1. The story and the goal

Whoever drinks from the River Lethe forgets.

Below the world of the living runs a black river. The dead must cross it to reach the **Far Shore**, where a veiled **Keeper** waits with one cup of river water. Drink it, and the weight of a whole life slips away.

An old ferryman carries the dead across, but only those who were buried with a coin for the fare. The others, the **coinless dead**, wake alone on the **near shore** and wander the bank. Fog fills them, and they begin to forget: first the small things, then the faces, then their own names. A soul that forgets everything simply fades into the mist.

You are the **Ferrymen**: servants of the underworld, neither living nor dead. The coinless the old ferryman will not carry are given to you. You have no boat. You have something stranger. Along the banks of Lethe grows the **Netherbloom**, a crimson flower of long, curling petals, blooming on a bare stalk with no leaves, because *flower and leaf never meet*. Its glow is the only light in the fog that a lost soul can follow. Where you plant Netherblooms, a soul can walk in the river toward the Far Shore.

One more thing: a soul's memories are not yours to tell. The Ferrymen may speak with one another on the water, but never of the memories they carry: only of the river, and of which threads of a life they hold in their hands.

The goal

Netherbloom is a co-operative game for 1 to 4 players and lasts about 15 turns. One soul starts on the near shore (space 0). All players win or lose together.

You win when the soul token reaches the Far Shore (space 12). The soul only moves onto spaces with a Bloom, so you place Roots ahead of it and turn them into Blooms. Along the way, some cards can be inscribed in the Book of Remembrance (section 9); the Book does not decide whether you win, but it decides how the story ends.

You lose at once if any of these happens:

- **Faded**: the forgotten pile reaches the Lantern's limit (section 10).
- **Shattered**: the soul has 3 Fractures.
- **Deluge**: you must place a Black Water token but none is left in the supply.

Forgetting cards helps and hurts. Many strong cards put cards on the forgotten pile, and with 6 or more forgotten cards the soul moves faster (section 4). But each forgotten card brings you closer to Faded.

The Veiled Memories

Talk as much as you like: plans, the board, the Loom, the Book and what each of you means to do next. But the memories stay veiled. Never show your hand, and never say a card's name, its effect, its Resonance or the memory written on it. You may say which threads you hold ("I have two Obsession and one Oblivion").

The **Echo** still matters: a card played on its thread as your Answer Resonates (section 3). When the game ends, the veil lifts, and one player reads the Book aloud.

2. Setting up

The picture on pages 2 and 3 shows the table set up for the Child of the Last Flame. Its numbers match the steps below. Appendix A shows every component.

1. **The river board.** Join the three panels in order: Reach I on the left (with the near shore) and Reach III on the right (ending at the Far Shore).
2. **Bank cards.** Sort the bank cards by the Reach number on their fog side: 6, 8, 6 cards for Reaches I, II and III. Shuffle each Reach's cards separately and place them fog side up on the banks of spaces 2-4, 5-8 and 9-11. Do not look at the other side.
3. **The first Blooms and the soul.** Space 1 has no bank cards: put a disc Bloom side up on both of its banks. Put the soul token on the near shore (space 0).
4. **The Soul and the Lantern.** Choose a Soul and a Lantern (section 10). Put the Soul card face up next to the board. The Child of the Last Flame starts with **3 Light** and the Bride Who Stayed Below with **1 Light**; every other Soul starts with 0.
5. **The Memory deck.** Shuffle the 32 core Memory cards with the Soul's 8-card pack (the 8 Echo cards for the Open Crossing) and put the deck face down. Leave room next to it for the **discard pile** (face up).
6. **The Mist decks.** Build one deck for each Reach: its 10 basic Mist cards, plus one *Rising Water* and one *Shade Drawn Near*, plus the Lantern's number of harsh Mist cards chosen at random (none at Gentle). Shuffle each deck and put it face down next to its Reach.
7. **The Loom of the Fates.** Put the Loom board out with its three threads, Obsession, Acceptance and Oblivion, and put the knots next to it. A thread is full at 4 knots with 2-3 players, and at 5 in solo play or with 4 players. Keep the Echo token next to the Loom: it goes onto a thread when the first card is played face up or Burned.
8. **The Mantles.** Put the four Mantle cards face up where everyone can reach them.
9. **The Book of Remembrance.** Open the chosen Soul's Book at page I, with the photo corners ready.
10. **The Ledger and the supply.** Put the Ledger board next to the Loom: forgotten cards go on its numbered track, Fractures on its Fracture wells. Put only the Lantern's number of Black Water tokens (6, 5, 4, 3 for Gentle, Standard, Hard, Heroic) in its Black Water well and the rest back in the box. Put the Root/Bloom discs, Shades, Light, Fractures, knots and the Hold Fast token, Shield token and Resignation token within reach.
11. **The Ferrymen.** Deal each player a hand: 4 cards in solo play, 3 with 2-4 players. Each player takes a Push Through token, face up. The first player takes the Oar. In solo play, shuffle the 12 Ghost cards into a face-down Ghost deck next to you.

From now on the Veiled Memories apply (section 1), and the first player takes the first turn.

3. Your turn

You lose at once if:

- **Faded**: the forgotten pile reaches your Lantern's ✕ on the Ledger.
- **Shattered**: the soul takes its 3rd Fracture (the last Fracture well on the Ledger).
- **Deluge**: you must place Black Water and the Ledger's Black Water well is empty.

You win when the soul reaches the Far Shore (space 12).

Players take turns clockwise, starting with the first player, who holds the Oar. On your turn:

1. **Summon a Mantle** (optional, before your first action; section 8).
2. **The Answer** (your first action): play a card (face up, face down or Burn), Recall or Push Through.
3. **The Steer** (your second action): play a card or Push Through. You may Burn only once per turn.
4. **End of turn**: carry out the end-of-turn steps (section 4).

Hand size is 4 in solo play and 3 with 2-4 players.

Playing a card

Play a card from your hand in one of three ways:

- **Face up**: do the card's effect, add one knot to its thread on the Loom, and move the Echo to that thread. Then put an Obsession or Acceptance card on the discard pile and an Oblivion card on the forgotten pile.
- **Face down**: place 1 Root (section 5). Ignore the card's printed effect. No knot is added and the Echo does not move. Then put the card face up on the discard pile.
- **Burn** (at most once per turn): choose another player who also holds a card of that card's thread. You each put one card of that thread face down on the table, then flip both. Choose one of the two cards: do its effect **twice**, add one knot to its thread, and move the Echo to that thread. Then forget both cards, and the other player draws 1 card at once. If no other player holds a card of the same thread, you cannot Burn. *Solo:* Burn one card from your hand: do its effect twice, add one knot, move the Echo, then forget the card and the top card of the deck.

1. Its thread (the icon), its name and ID
2. What it does when played face up
3. Its Resonance: what it also does when it matches the Echo
4. The painting
5. The memory it carries, and which line of the Book it fills (Place, Person, Deed or Feeling)

A Memory card. Oblivion cards have no Book slot: after use they go on the forgotten pile.

Recall and Push Through

Recall (Answer only): spend 3 **Light** and choose any card in the forgotten pile; put it on the discard pile, so it can be drawn again later. A forgotten Key Memory can be Recalled.

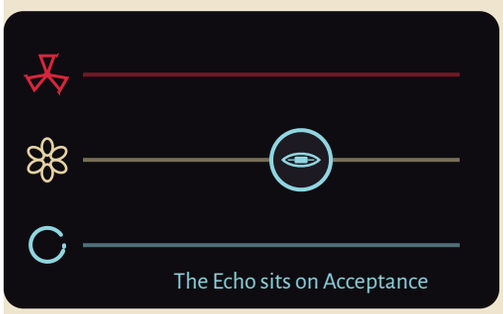
Push Through (each player only **once per game**): only when Shades are on **both** banks of the next space and that space has no Black Water. Return both Shades to the supply, move the soul onto that space (gain its Light as usual, section 8) and flip your Push Through token face down. The soul then takes 1 **Fracture**, plus 1 more for each Push Through token that was already face down, and you forget the top card of the deck. So the first Push Through costs 1 Fracture, the second 2 and the third 3 (which means Shattered). Your turn continues as usual.

The Echo and Resonance

The **Echo** token sits on the thread of the last card played face up or Burned, by any player (or the Ghost). It does not move for a card played face down, a Recall or a Push Through.

If your **Answer** is a card played face up or Burned on the Echo's thread, the card **Resonates**: also do its Resonance effect. On some Oblivion cards the Resonance replaces the normal effect ("Instead"). A Resonating card may be inscribed in the Book of Remembrance (section 9).

Your Steer never Resonates. If your Answer is a Recall or a Push Through, you cannot Resonate this turn. For a Burn, the card that Resonates is the one whose effect you double.



Played as your Answer: Resonates

Another thread: no Resonance

The last card played face up was an Acceptance card, so the Echo is on Acceptance. If your Answer is an Acceptance card, it Resonates: you also do its Resonance, and it may be inscribed in the Book.

Forgetting and the two piles

Forget a card: put it face up on the next number of the Ledger's forgotten track, overlapping the card before it. The number above the newest card is how many cards are forgotten. **Forget the top card of the deck**: put the top card of the Memory deck on the forgotten track without playing it. If a card leaves the forgotten pile (Recall, a Chapter Blessing), slide the later cards back.

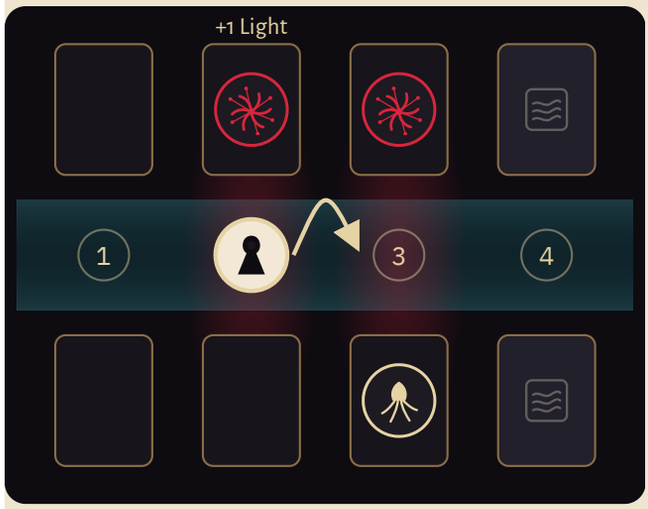
The **discard pile** (next to the deck) and the **forgotten pile** (on the Ledger) are both face up, and anyone may look through them. Keep them apart: discarded cards come back when the deck runs out, forgotten cards do not. If the Memory deck is empty when you need to draw or forget, shuffle the discard pile into a new deck first.

4. The end of the turn

The end-of-turn steps happen after **every player's turn**, not once per round. Do them in this order:

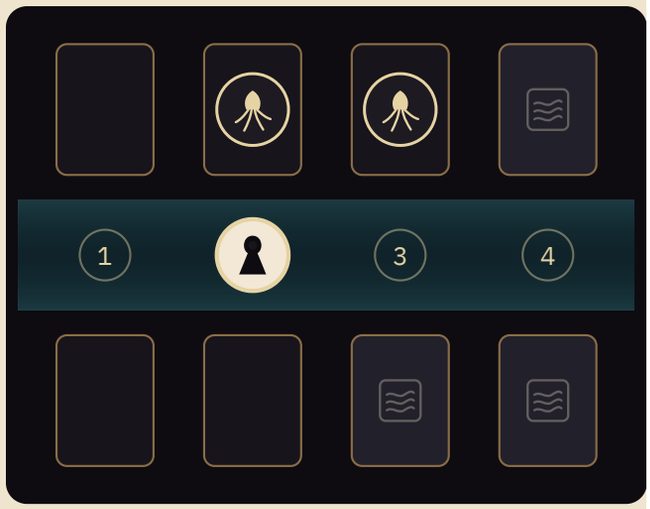
1. **Bloom-Bringer.** If the active player holds the Bloom-Bringer, they may flip one Root on the soul's space or ahead of it to its Bloom side, for free.
2. **Soul Step.** Check these in order and do the first that applies:
   a. **Is the Resignation token next to the soul?** The soul does not move. Forget the top card of the deck (nothing can prevent this), then remove the token. Go to *e*.
   b. **Is the next space Lit and free of Black Water?** Move the soul onto it. Gain 1 Light for each Bloom on the space the soul moved off, then return all discs and Shades on that space to the supply. If the soul has moved onto the first space of a new Reach, remove all knots from the Loom (the Echo stays on its thread).
   c. **Extra move.** If *9* or more cards are forgotten (**Adrift**), the soul moves one more space. If that space is Lit and free of Black Water, it simply moves there. If not, it moves there anyway and takes 1 Fracture, unless the Spirit Warden is unused: then turn the Warden sideways, and the soul does not take the extra move. Otherwise, if *6* or more cards are forgotten (**Light as Ash**), the soul moves one more space, but only if that space is Lit and free of Black Water. Each extra move also gives Light for the space the soul moves off.
   d. **The soul cannot move: it Lingers** (it stays where it is). Check these in order and apply the first that fits: the Hold Fast token is next to the soul, so nothing is forgotten; the Spirit Warden is unused, so turn it sideways and nothing is forgotten; the soul's own space is Lit, so nothing is forgotten; the Bride, once per game, moves back one space instead (section 10). Otherwise, **forget the top card of the deck**.
   e. **Shade damage.** If there is a Shade on either bank of the soul's space (one or two), the soul takes **1 Fracture**. This happens whether the soul moved or Lingered.
3. **Mist.** Flip the top card of the Mist deck of the Reach the soul is in now and carry out its instructions in order. "Ahead of the soul" is counted from the soul's space: 1 space ahead is the next space. Then put the card face up on that Reach's Mist discard pile. If the deck is empty, first shuffle that Reach's 10 basic Mist cards (only) into a new deck. Appendix C lists every Mist card.
4. **Cleanup.**
   - For each space with Black Water and a disc (Root or Bloom) on **both** banks: remove the Black Water token from the game (put it in the box).
   - For each Shade with a Bloom on the same bank of the space directly before it **and** the space directly after it: return the Shade to the supply.
5. **Draw** back up to your hand size.
6. **Solo: the Ghost** (section 11). Then do Cleanup again.
7. **Pass the Oar** to the player on your left. In solo play it comes back to you after the Ghost.

The next space is Lit



The soul moves. Gain 1 Light for each Bloom on the space it moved off, then clear that space.

The next space is not Lit



The soul Lingers (stays put). If its own space is not Lit, forget the top card of the deck; if it is Lit, nothing else happens.

At the start of the next turn

- Remove the ⚓ Hold Fast token if it is out.
- If you hold the Spirit Warden, straighten it at the start of your own turn.
- A 🛡 Shield token that has not cancelled a 🧠 Fracture is removed at the end of its owner's next turn.

Effects that happen immediately

A thread that becomes full causes its **Backlash** at once (section 6). A page reward and a Chapter Blessing happen at once, as soon as the inscription that earns them is made (section 9). A 🏠 Memory Site gives its keepsake (and, in the Open Crossing, its 🕯 Light) when its bank card is flipped. The game ends the moment the soul reaches the Far Shore (you win), the forgotten pile reaches the Lantern's limit (Faded), the soul takes its third 🧠 Fracture (Shattered), or a 〰 Black Water token must be placed with none left in the supply (Deluge). A Fracture cancelled by a 🛡 Shield token or by the Child's rule is not taken.

Reach I

Reach II

Reach III

Harsh Mist

Mist cards from each Reach, and a Harsh Mist card. Positions count from the soul's space.

5. The river, Roots and Blooms

The river has 13 spaces: the near shore (0), spaces 1 to 11, and the Far Shore (12). Each space from 1 to 11 has a **left** and a **right bank**, and each bank holds at most one disc or token. Banks are named as you face downstream toward the Far Shore. "Ahead of the soul" means the spaces with a higher number than the soul's space; "the next space" is the space directly ahead.

The river has three Reaches: **Reach I, the Asphodel Road** (spaces 1-4), **Reach II, the Fields of Mourning** (5-8) and **Reach III, the Banks of Lethe** (9-11). Each Reach has its own Mist deck and its own page in the Book of Remembrance.

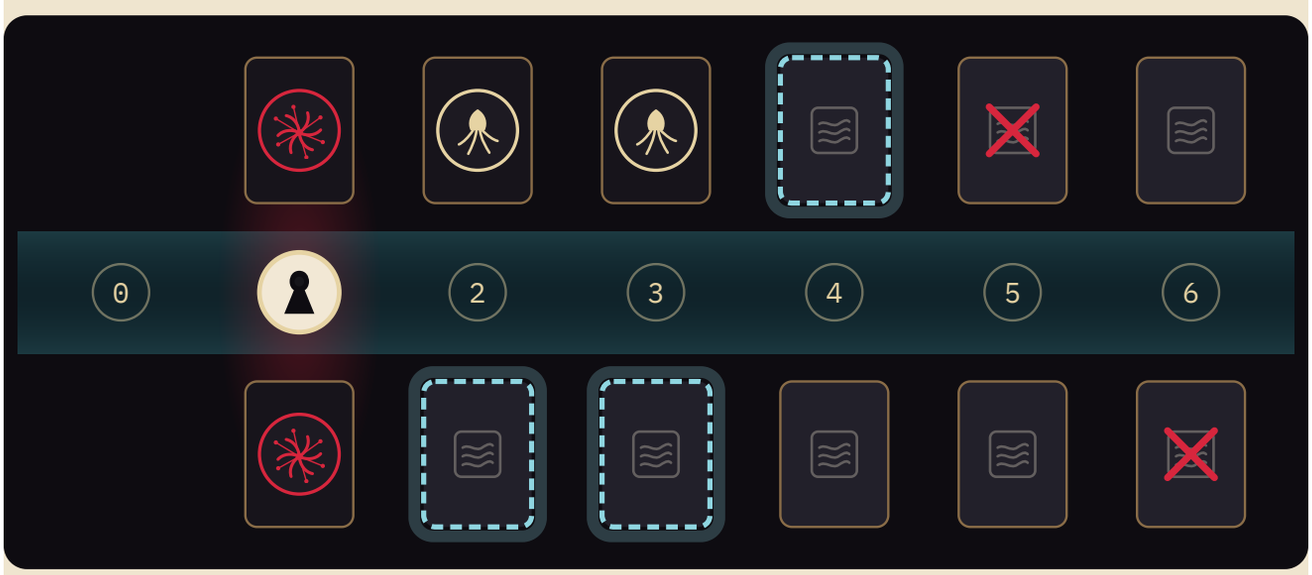
Roots, Blooms and the network

A **Root** is a disc Root side up; a **Bloom** is the same disc Bloom side up. A space is **Lit** when at least one of its banks has a Bloom. The soul only moves onto Lit spaces.

Placing a Root. Put a disc Root side up on an empty bank (no disc, no Shade) on the soul's space or ahead of it. The bank must **touch the network**, meaning at least one of these is true:

- it is on the soul's space or the next space, or
- the other bank of the same space has a disc, or
- the same bank (left or right) of the space directly before or after it has a disc.

Blooming a Root. Flip a Root on the soul's space or ahead of it to its Bloom side. **Withering a Bloom.** Flip a Bloom back to its Root side; the space may stop being Lit.



The soul is on space 1, which its Blooms Light. The glowing banks are the only places a new Root may go: the lower banks of spaces 2 and 3 face a Root across the water, and the upper bank of space 4 follows the Root on space 3 along the same bank. The crossed-out banks touch nothing, so no Root can grow there.

Bank cards

When you place a Root on a bank that is still covered by fog, flip its bank card face up. The card stays on the bank, and its type decides what happens:

- **Fertile:** place the Root.

- **Stony**: place the Root only if the card's effect says "even on Stony ground" or you hold the Root-Weaver. Otherwise no Root is placed, and that Root is lost.
- **Memory Site**: place the Root and take a keepsake. In the Open Crossing, also gain 2 Light.
- **Grave**: no Root is placed. Put a Shade on this bank.

A bank with no bank card (both banks of space 1, or a bank whose Grave card was removed) counts as Fertile. A face-up bank card follows the same rules: Roots can be placed on Fertile and Memory Site banks, on Stony banks only as described above, and never on a Grave. Reach I has 3 Fertile, 1 Stony and 2 Memory Site cards; Reach II has 3 Fertile, 2 Stony, 2 Memory Site and 1 Grave; Reach III has 2 Fertile, 1 Stony, 2 Memory Site and 1 Grave.

The fog side

The four kinds of bank card, and the fog side they are placed with. When a Root is placed on a fog card, flip the card face up.

6. The Loom of the Fates and Backlash

The Loom has three threads: Obsession, Acceptance and Oblivion. Each card played face up or Burned adds one knot to its thread. A thread is full at 4 knots with 2-3 players, and at 5 in solo play or with 4 players.

When a thread becomes full, remove all its knots and resolve its **Backlash**:

- **Obsession, Grasping**: place a Shade on the soul's space: on the left bank if it is free, otherwise on the right bank. If both banks already have a Shade (or the soul is on the near shore), place it on the left bank of the next space instead (or the right bank if the left is taken).
- **Acceptance, Resignation**: put the Resignation token next to the soul. In the next Soul Step the soul does not move and you forget the top card of the deck; then remove the token.
- **Oblivion, the Tide Rises**: place a Black Water token on the next space (section 7).

When the soul moves onto the first space of a new Reach, remove all knots from all three threads. The Echo stays where it is.

Each card played face up or Burned ties a knot on its thread. With 2–3 players a thread holds 4 knots: here the Acceptance thread is full, so it snaps, its Backlash happens, and it is emptied.

7. Black Water, Shades and Fractures

Placing ≋ Black Water. Put a Black Water token on the space named. If that space already has Black Water, use the first space after it without Black Water; if there is none ahead, use the nearest space between it and the soul. Black Water is never placed on the soul's own space. Flip every ✳ Bloom on that space to its Root side. The soul cannot move onto a space with Black Water. Black Water is always taken from the Ledger's Black Water well. If you must place Black Water and the well is empty, you lose (Deluge).

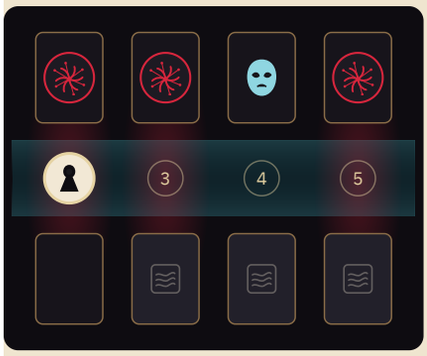
Removing ≋ Black Water. In Cleanup, if both banks of a space with Black Water have a disc, remove the Black Water token from the game. Cards that say "drain" remove Black Water the same way. Removed Black Water goes in the box and never returns to the well.

Placing a Shade. Put the Shade on the bank named. If that bank already has a Shade, use the other bank of the same space; if both are taken, continue with the next space ahead. A disc on that bank is returned to the supply. No Root can be placed on a bank with a Shade. Shades on both banks of the next space stop the soul unless a player Pushes Through (section 3).

Removing Shades. In Cleanup, return a Shade to the supply if the same bank of the space directly before it and the space directly after it both have a ✳ Bloom. Cards that say "banish" or "wash away" also return Shades to the supply. The bank card under a removed Shade stays as it was.

Fractures come from Shade damage, Push Through, Adrift and the harsh Mist card *Dark Wind*. Put each one on the next Fracture well of the Ledger; a mended Fracture comes off the highest well. At 3 Fractures you lose (Shattered). The card *Hold the Line* gives the Shield token: it cancels the next Fracture, then is removed; if unused, it is removed at the end of its owner's next turn.

Removing a Shade

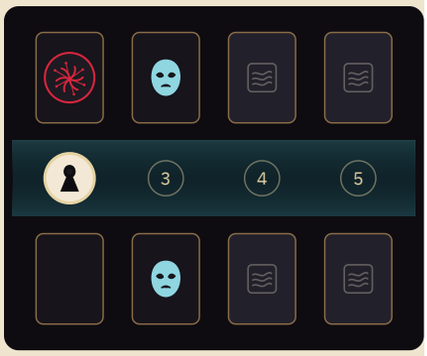


A Bloom on the same bank directly before and after a Shade: in Cleanup, return the Shade to the supply.

Removing Black Water

Black Water on a space with a Root or Bloom on both banks: in Cleanup, remove the Black Water from the game.

Shades on both banks



Shades on both banks of the next space: the soul cannot move there unless a player uses an action to Push Through.

8. Light and Mantles

Gaining Light. Light is one shared pool. Each time the soul moves off a space, gain 1 Light for each Bloom on that space (2 Light if both banks have a Bloom); the space is then cleared, so each Bloom gives Light only once. This happens whenever the soul moves: in the Soul Step, in extra moves, by a card that moves the soul, or by a Push Through. Light stays in the pool until it is spent or lost to the harsh Mist card *Dark Wind*. The Open Crossing also gains 2 Light for each Memory Site flipped.

Spending Light. Recall a forgotten card as your Answer (3 Light, section 3), or summon a Mantle.

Summoning a Mantle (before your Answer): pay 3 Light (2 with the King on the Barge) and discard one card from your hand with the same thread as the Mantle. Take the Mantle card. With 2-4 players, each player holds at most one Mantle and keeps it for the rest of the game. In solo play see section 11.

- **The Root-Weaver** (Obsession): Your Roots may grow on Stony ground. Your first Root effect each turn places 1 extra Root.
- **The Spirit Warden** (Obsession): Once per round, stop the soul from Lingering or from drifting Adrift.
- **The Bloom-Bringer** (Acceptance): At the end of each of your turns, Bloom 1 Root for free.
- **The Fog-Breaker** (Oblivion): Your first Oblivion card each turn is discarded instead of forgotten.

Spirit Warden. "Once per round" means once between the start of the holder's turn and the start of their next turn; it also works on other players' turns. When it is used, turn the card sideways; straighten it at the start of the holder's turn. When it stops a Linger, the soul stays where it is but no card is forgotten. When it stops Adrift (only when the extra space is not Lit or has Black Water), the soul does not take the extra move and takes no Fracture.

Bloom-Bringer. Its power is used only in end-of-turn step 1 of the holder's own turn.

The four Mantle cards.

9. The Book of Remembrance and the ending

The Book has one page per Reach: page I, *Who I Was* (Reach I); page II, *What I Did* (Reach II); page III, *What I Carry* (Reach III). Each page has four slots, **Place**, **Person**, **Deed** and **Feeling**, which complete a sentence about the soul's life.

Inscribing. When a card Resonates, you may inscribe it if the slot shown on the card is still empty on the page of the Reach the soul is in. A **Key Memory** may be inscribed whenever it is played face up, Resonating or not. To inscribe, put the card in its slot with photo corners instead of discarding it; it stays there for the rest of the game. Oblivion cards and Burned cards cannot be inscribed.

Page rewards. Each page pays a small reward for each pair of neighbouring slots: **Place + Person**, **Person + Deed** and **Deed + Feeling**. When an inscription fills the second slot of a pair, do that pair's reward at once. One card can complete two pairs (a Person inscribed next to a Place and a Deed): do both. Each reward happens once per page; tick its box in the Book. The rewards are printed on each page:

Page	Place + Person	Person + Deed	Deed + Feeling
I · Who I Was	Place 1 Root.	Bloom 1 Root.	Gain 2 Light.
II · What I Did	Banish the nearest Shade.	Drain the nearest Black Water.	Untie 1 knot on the fullest thread (if tied, you choose).
III · What I Carry	Return the newest forgotten card to the discard pile.	Mend 1 Fracture.	The soul steps forward now, if the next space is Lit.

Chapter Blessing. When all 4 slots of a page are filled (3 for the Garland Girl), the page also gives one Chapter Blessing at once (only once per page). The Blessing is not chosen. Check these in order and do the first one that is possible:

1. If the soul has at least one Fracture: remove 1 Fracture (from the highest well).
2. Otherwise, if any space has Black Water: remove the Black Water token closest ahead of the soul from the game.
3. Otherwise, if the forgotten pile has any cards: move the newest forgotten card to the discard pile.
4. Otherwise nothing happens.

I · Who I Was

I was born near *the gate I swore never to leave*. I loved *my mother, humming at the loom*. I once *…but this, the river has taken*, and ever since I have carried *…but this, the river has taken*.

Page I of a Book of Remembrance, half written: two memories inscribed, two slots still empty. If the crossing ended now, the empty ones would read as the river taking them.

The ending

When the game ends, the veil lifts. Check where the soul's **Key Memory** card is:

- **Inscribed in the Book**: the soul crosses remembering what mattered most.
- **In the forgotten pile**: the soul crosses without it, lighter and emptier.
- **Anywhere else** (deck, a hand or the discard pile): it was never spoken, and the soul crosses with it unsaid.

Then read the Book aloud, page by page, even after a loss. Empty slots are read as "…but this, the river has taken".

10. The Souls and the Lantern

Four souls the old ferryman would not carry, and one with no name at all.

Each named Soul adds its own 8-card pack of memories, including one **Key Memory**, and one special rule. The Open Crossing adds the 8 Echo cards instead.

Child of the Last Flame

A small child alone in a doorway on the coldest night of the year, with a handful of little lights to sell and none sold. To keep warm she lights them one by one, and in each flame she sees something: a warm stove, a feast, and at last the one person who ever held her, coming to take her home.

Special rule: Starts with 3 Light. The first Fracture in each Reach is ignored. Never drifts Adrift. She can forget 1 more card before she Fades. No harsh Mist. Turn her Soul card sideways when a Fracture is ignored, and straighten it when the soul moves onto the first space of a new Reach. **Key Memory:** *the one who used to hold me before she was gone.*

The Garland Girl

A young woman who wove a flower for everyone she loved. Her father died, the man who promised to marry her turned cruel, and she gave her flowers away one by one and slipped into a brook still singing. She kept one flower for herself, and no one ever learned which.

Special rule: Each page gives its Chapter Blessing at only 3 inscribed memories. **Key Memory:** *the one flower I kept for myself.*

The King on the Barge

An old king who won every battle but the last. His closest friend loved his queen, his fellowship broke apart, and he fell on a field of his own making. Dying, he was laid on a black barge. The sword he was lent was never returned to the water it came from, and so he cannot rest.

Special rule: Mantles cost 2 Light. A Fracture strips the Mantle of the player who caused it. The active player loses their Mantle when the soul takes a Fracture during their turn (including its end-of-turn steps); put the Mantle back with the others, and it can be summoned again. **Key Memory:** *the hand that rose from the lake to give me a sword.*

The Bride Who Stayed Below

She died on her wedding day. Her husband came down into the dark to bring her back, on one condition: he must not look back until they reached the light. One step from the surface, he turned. She has stood in the shadows ever since, deciding whether to remember his face or let it go.

Special rule: Starts with 1 Light. The first time she would Linger in the dark, she is pulled one space back instead of forgetting. This happens only when her own space is not Lit and nothing else stops the Linger. Turn her Soul card sideways once it has been used. **Key Memory:** *his face, the instant he turned to look at me.*

Open Crossing

A nameless soul. You do not learn its story; you write it.

Special rule: Memory Sites give +2 Light. There is no Key Memory; the Book is the soul's whole story.

The five Soul cards.

The Lantern

The Lantern sets the difficulty. **Standard** is the normal game: an experienced group should win about half its games. Use **Gentle** for learning, and **Hard** or **Heroic** for more challenge.

Lantern	Black Water supply	Faded at	Harsh Mist per Reach
◆◇◇◇ Gentle	6	11 forgotten	0
◆◆◇◇ Standard	5	10 forgotten	2
◆◆◆◇ Hard	4	9 forgotten	3
◆◆◆◆ Heroic	3	8 forgotten	3

Your first game: we suggest **Child of the Last Flame** at the Gentle Lantern. Its rules forgive more mistakes while you learn the river, the Loom and the Book.

II. Solo play and the Ghost

In solo play you hold 4 cards and each Loom thread is full at 5 knots.

The Ghost. After each of your turns (end-of-turn step 6), flip the top card of the Ghost deck and do its action, using the same placement rules as a player (section 5). Then add a knot to its thread (a full thread causes a Backlash) and move the Echo there, so your next Answer can Resonate with it. When the Ghost deck is empty, shuffle all Ghost cards into a new deck.

Replacing a Mantle. You may summon a new Mantle while you hold one. Flip the old Mantle face down: it can never be summoned again. Each Mantle can be summoned only once, and you may summon at most 3 times per game.

Ghost card	×	Action
Obsession	3	Roots on the furthest open bank
Obsession	2	Roots on the nearest open bank
Acceptance	2	Blooms the nearest Root
Acceptance	2	Blooms the furthest Root
Oblivion	2	Banishes the nearest Shade, or drains Black Water
Oblivion	1	Does nothing

Ghost cards: one of each thread.

Appendix A. Components and symbols

Each component, what it represents in the story, and what it does in the game.

Component	In the story	In the game
Soul token	A coinless dead person, waking on the near shore with a whole life still inside them.	Moves from space 0 to space 12, only onto Lit spaces without Black Water.
The Far Shore	Where the veiled Keeper waits with the cup of forgetting.	Space 12. When the soul reaches it, you win.
Bank card, fog side	The mist that hides the bank.	Covers a bank until a Root is placed there (section 5).

Component	In the story	In the game
Fertile	Soft riverbank earth.	A Root is placed.
Stony	Hard, grey stone where little can grow.	A Root is placed only by a card that allows Stony ground or the Root-Weaver.
Memory Site	A place the soul once knew, surfacing through the fog.	A Root is placed; take a keepsake (Open Crossing: also 2 Light).
Grave	Something unfinished is buried here.	No Root; a Shade is placed instead.
Root (disc)	A Netherbloom seed, planted in the dark.	Extends the network. Does not light a space.
Bloom (disc)	An open Netherbloom, glowing crimson.	Makes its space Lit.
Light	The glow of the flowers the soul has passed.	Shared pool; spent on Mantles and Recall.
Obsession thread	Clinging, grudges, things the soul cannot let go.	Mostly Root cards. Backlash: Grasping.
Acceptance thread	Tenderness, forgiveness, peace.	Mostly Bloom and Mend cards. Backlash: Resignation.
Oblivion thread	Deliberate forgetting.	Strong cards; forgotten after use. Backlash: the Tide Rises.
Knot	The Fates' weaving of the soul's last journey.	Marks how full a thread is on the Loom.
Echo token	The shuttle of the Loom, carrying each thread to the next hand.	Shows the thread a card must match to Resonate.
Shade	A restless shade of the soul's unfinished resentment.	Blocks a bank; damages the soul beside it.
Black Water	The river rising to swallow the path.	The soul cannot enter its space.
Fracture	A crack in the soul's sense of self.	Goes on the Ledger's Fracture wells. Third one: Shattered.
Oar	The ferry's oar, passed hand to hand.	Shows whose turn it is.
Push Through token	A Ferryman's one hard shove.	One per player; flipped face down when used.
Hold Fast token	An anchor let down beside the soul.	If the soul Lingers, nothing is forgotten.
Shield token	A Ferryman between the soul and harm.	Cancels the next Fracture.
Resignation token	The soul, sitting down among the reeds.	The soul does not move in the next Soul Step.
Book of Remembrance	The spring of Memory the dead were told to seek instead of Lethe.	Three pages of four slots each (section 9).
Key Memory	The memory that matters most to this soul.	Decides the ending (section 9).
The Ledger	The river's account of what the soul is losing.	Holds the forgotten pile on a numbered track, the Fractures and the Black Water supply: the three ways to lose.

Component	In the story	In the game
Memory cards	The soul's memories.	Your hand; each has an effect, a thread and usually a Book slot.
Mist cards	The underworld itself: rising water, cold wind, returning fog.	One deck per Reach; one is flipped each turn (Appendix C).
Mantle cards	Roles a Ferryman can take up on the river.	Lasting powers bought with Light (section 8).
Soul cards	The five souls you can carry.	Each has a special rule (section 10).
Ghost cards (solo)	A silent Ferryman who travels beside you.	Played after each of your turns (section 11).

What is in the box

Component	Count
Memory cards	72: 32 core, 8 Echo cards (Open Crossing), 4 Soul packs of 8
Mist cards	42: 10 basic for each Reach, 2 extra for each Reach (Rising Water, Shade Drawn Near), 6 harsh
Bank cards	20: 6, 8, 6 for Reaches I, II, III
Soul cards / Mantle cards / Ghost cards	5 / 4 / 12
Boards	3 river board panels, 1 Loom of the Fates, 1 Ledger
Books of Remembrance	5, one for each Soul
Root/Bloom discs	24
Shades / Black Water / Fractures	8 / 6 / 3
Light / knots	12 / 15
Echo, Oar, soul (Ghost on the back)	1 each
Push Through / Hold Fast / Shield / Resignation tokens	4 / 1 / 1 / 1

Cards that track their own use. Turn the Spirit Warden card sideways when it is used, and straighten it at the start of its holder's turn. Turn a Soul card sideways when its once-only rule has been used. In solo play, flip a Mantle you give up face down.

Appendix B. Card terms

Words printed in ◆ THIS STYLE on the cards are game terms. This table says exactly what to do.

Words on the card	What you do
Place N Roots	Put N discs Root side up, one at a time, each on an empty bank that touches the network (section 5). *Even on Stony ground*: Stony banks are allowed too.
◆ Bloom N Roots	Flip N Roots on the soul's space or ahead of it to the Bloom side.

Words on the card	What you do
◆Wither	Flip a Bloom to its Root side. The space may stop being Lit.
◆Lit	A space with a Bloom on at least one bank. The soul moves only onto Lit spaces.
◆Mend N Fractures	Take N Fractures off the Ledger, from the highest well down, and return them to the supply.
◆Banish the nearest Shade	Return the Shade closest to the soul (on its space or ahead) to the supply.
◆Wash away the Shades beside the soul	Return every Shade on the soul's space to the supply.
◆Drain the nearest Black Water	Remove the Black Water token closest ahead of the soul and put it in the box. *Drain all Black Water in this Reach*: do this for every Black Water token in the soul's Reach.
Remove 1 of your choice: the nearest Shade or the nearest Black Water	Do one of the two rows above: Banish the nearest Shade, or Drain the nearest Black Water.
◆Untie N knots on the fullest thread	Remove N knots from the thread with the most knots. No Backlash. If threads are tied, you choose.
Empty the fullest thread	Remove every knot from the thread with the most knots. No Backlash. If threads are tied, you choose.
◆Tie N knots	Add N knots to the thread named. If this fills it, resolve its Backlash.
◆Backlash	What a full thread does (section 6). Resolve it, then remove that thread's knots.
◆Lift the fog across this Reach; Graves turn Fertile	Flip every fog-side-up bank card in the soul's Reach face up without placing Roots. Remove every Grave card flipped this way from the board: those banks count as Fertile. Cards flipped this way cause no Shade, keepsake or Light.
The soul steps forward now	Move the soul to the next space now, if it is Lit and has no Black Water. Gain its Light as usual.
The soul waits without forgetting this turn	Put the Hold Fast token next to the soul. If the soul Lingers this turn, no card is forgotten.
Prevent the next Fracture	Take the Shield token (section 7).
Read the top 3 Mist cards	Look at the top 3 cards of the current Reach's Mist deck and put them back on top in any order.
◆Forget a card / ◆forgotten	Put the card face up on the next number of the Ledger's forgotten track.
◆Forget the top card of the deck	Put the top card of the Memory deck on the forgotten track without playing it.
◆Linger	The soul does not move in the Soul Step (section 4, step d).
◆Summon a Mantle	Before your Answer: pay 3 Light (2 with the King on the Barge) and discard 1 card from your hand of the Mantle's thread. Take the Mantle card.
Recall	As your Answer: pay 3 Light and move any card from the forgotten pile to the discard pile.

Words on the card	What you do
Burn	Once per turn, with another player who holds the same thread: you each reveal a card of that thread and you choose one; do its effect twice, tie 1 knot and move the Echo there. Forget both cards; the other player draws 1. Solo: Burn one card, effect twice, then forget it and the top card of the deck.
Resonance / Resonates	Your Answer is played face up or Burned on the Echo's thread: also do the card's Resonance effect. *Instead*: do the Resonance effect in place of the normal one.
Inscribe	Put a Resonating card in its slot on the current Reach's Book page instead of discarding it (section 9).
Remove the Echo from the Loom (Mist)	Take the Echo token off its thread. No card can Resonate until a card is played face up or Burned again.

Appendix C. Mist cards

The instructions printed on each Mist card. Each Reach's deck also holds *Rising Water* and 😶 *Shade Drawn Near* and, at every Lantern except Gentle, harsh cards.

Mist card	Reach	Instructions
Rising Water	I, II, III	Place 1 Black Water 2 spaces ahead of the soul (if that space is flooded, the next one).
Shade	I, II	Place 1 Shade on the left bank 1 space ahead of the soul.
Shade Drawn Near	I, II, III	Place 1 Shade on the soul's space (left bank first; if both are taken, the left bank of the next space).
Withering	I, II, III	The 2 Blooms furthest ahead of the soul wither to Roots.
Fog Returns	I, II	Turn the 1 furthest revealed empty bank back to fog.
Cold Wind	I, II, III	Forget the top 1 card of the deck.
The Mist Parts	I	No effect.
Echo Severed	II, III	Remove the Echo from the Loom.
Undertow	III	Place 1 Black Water 2 spaces ahead of the soul (if that space is flooded, the next one). The Bloom 1 space ahead of the soul withers to a Root.
Twin Shades	III	Place 1 Shade on the left bank 2 spaces ahead of the soul. Place 1 Shade on the right bank 2 spaces ahead of the soul.
Great Withering	III	The 3 Blooms furthest ahead of the soul wither to Roots.
Bitter Wind	III	Forget the top 2 cards of the deck.
Flood Surge	Harsh	Place 1 Black Water 1 space ahead of the soul (if that space is flooded, the next one). Place 1 Black Water 3 spaces ahead of the soul (if that space is flooded, the next one).

Mist card	Reach	Instructions
Shade Host	Harsh	Place 1 Shade on the left bank 1 space ahead of the soul. Place 1 Shade on the right bank 1 space ahead of the soul.
Wither Storm	Harsh	Every Bloom more than 2 spaces ahead of the soul withers to a Root.
Deep Cold	Harsh	Forget the top 2 cards of the deck.
Karma Surge	Harsh	Tie 1 knot on every thread.
Dark Wind	Harsh	Lose 2 Light; with less than 2 Light, suffer 1 Fracture instead.

Appendix D. Card reference

Card	Face up	Resonance
Deep Roots	Place 2 Roots.	Place 1 Root.
Echo card `Open Crossing`	Place 2 Roots.	Place 1 Root.
Echo card `Open Crossing`	The soul waits without forgetting this turn.	Place 1 Root.
Echo card `Open Crossing`	Read the top 3 Mist cards and put them back on top in any order.	Place 1 Root.
Hold Fast	The soul waits without forgetting this turn.	Place 1 Root.
Hold the Line	Prevent the next Fracture before your next turn.	Place 1 Root.
Old Oath	Gain 2 Light.	Gain 1 Light.
Overreach	Place 3 Roots. Tie 1 extra Obsession knot.	Bloom 1 Root.
Stubborn Root	Place 1 Root, even on Stony ground.	Place 1 Root, even on Stony ground.
Vigil	Read the top 3 Mist cards and put them back on top in any order.	Place 1 Root.
Echo card `Open Crossing`	Bloom 1 Root. Place 1 Root.	Bloom 1 Root.
Echo card `Open Crossing`	Bloom 2 Roots.	Gain 1 Light.
Echo card `Open Crossing`	Mend 1 Fracture.	Bloom 1 Root.
Full Bloom	Bloom 2 Roots.	Gain 1 Light.
Guide	The soul steps forward now, if the next space is Lit.	Bloom 1 Root.
Held `Key Memory`	Mend 1 Fracture.	Bloom 1 Root.
His Face `Key Memory`	The soul steps forward now, if the next space is Lit.	Bloom 1 Root.

Card	Face up	Resonance
❀ **Let Go**	Untie 2 knots on the fullest thread (if tied, you choose).	Untie 1 knot on the fullest thread (if tied, you choose).
❀ **Mend**	Mend 1 Fracture.	Bloom 1 Root.
❀ **One Flower Kept** `Key Memory`	Bloom 1 Root. Gain 1 Light.	Bloom 1 Root.
❀ **Open Hand**	Bloom 1 Root. Place 1 Root.	Bloom 1 Root.
❀ **Rekindle**	Bloom 1 Root. Gain 1 Light.	Bloom 1 Root.
❀ **The Lake's Gift** `Key Memory`	Bloom 1 Root. Place 1 Root.	Bloom 1 Root.
○ **Blank Fog**	Lift the fog across this Reach; Graves turn Fertile.	Gain 2 Light.
○ **Echo card** `Open Crossing`	Remove 1 of your choice: the nearest Shade or the nearest Black Water.	Instead: Remove the nearest Shade and the nearest Black Water.
○ **Echo card** `Open Crossing`	Gain 3 Light.	Bloom 1 Root.
○ **Lethe's Gift**	Gain 3 Light.	Bloom 1 Root.
○ **Low Tide**	Drain all Black Water in this Reach.	Banish the nearest Shade.
○ **Unmake**	Empty the fullest thread with no Backlash (if tied, you choose).	Gain 1 Light.
○ **Unremember**	Remove 1 of your choice: the nearest Shade or the nearest Black Water.	Instead: Remove the nearest Shade and the nearest Black Water.
○ **Wash Away**	Wash away the Shades beside the soul.	Gain 1 Light.

Player Aid

Everything needed to play, in the order you need it. The Rulebook explains the same rules in full.

Win and lose

You win when the soul reaches the Far Shore (space 12). Everyone wins or loses together.

You lose at once if:

- **Faded**: the forgotten pile reaches your Lantern's limit (8-11 cards; the ✕ on the Ledger).
- **Shattered**: the soul takes its 3rd Fracture.
- **Deluge**: you must place Black Water and the Ledger's Black Water well is empty.

Talking: the Veiled Memories

Talk freely about plans and the table, and say which threads you hold ("2 Obsession, 1 Oblivion"). Never show your hand or say a card's name, effect, Resonance or memory.

Setup

1. **River**: join the 3 panels (Reach I left, III right). Shuffle each Reach's bank cards separately and lay them fog side up on its banks (spaces 2-4, 5-8, 9-11). A Bloom on both banks of space 1; the soul token on space 0.
2. **Soul and Lantern**: choose both. The Soul card's special rule applies all game. Starting Light: the Child 3, the Bride 1, others 0.
3. **Lantern**: Gentle: 6 Black Water, Faded at 11, 0 harsh Mist per Reach; Standard: 5 Black Water, Faded at 10, 2 harsh Mist per Reach; Hard: 4 Black Water, Faded at 9, 3 harsh Mist per Reach; Heroic: 3 Black Water, Faded at 8, 3 harsh Mist per Reach.
4. **Memory deck**: the 32 core cards plus the Soul's 8 (the 8 Echo cards for the Open Crossing), shuffled face down. Leave room for a face-up discard pile.
5. **Mist decks**: one per Reach: its 10 basic cards, plus Rising Water and Shade Drawn Near, plus the Lantern's number of random harsh cards. Shuffle each.
6. **Loom**: knots beside it; the Echo token beside it (it goes on a thread at the first card played face up or Burned).
7. **Ledger**: the Lantern's Black Water tokens in its well (the rest back in the box); Fractures beside it. Forgotten cards will go on its numbered track.
8. **Mantles** face up; the Soul's **Book** open at page I; the rest of the tokens in a supply.
9. **Players**: deal each a hand of 3 (4 in solo); each takes a Push Through token face up; the first player takes the Oar. Solo: shuffle the Ghost cards into a deck.

On your turn

1. **Summon a Mantle** (optional, before your Answer): pay 3 Light (2 with the King) and discard a card of the Mantle's thread; take the Mantle. One Mantle per player for the game (solo: you may swap it for another, the old one is gone for good; at most 3 summons).
2. **Answer** (first action), one of:
   - play a card: **face up**, **face down** or **Burn** (below);
   - **Recall**: pay 3 Light and move any card from the forgotten pile to the discard pile;
   - **Push Through** (below).

Only the Answer can **Resonate**: a card played face up or Burned as your Answer on the thread the Echo sits on also does its Resonance effect (”Instead” replaces the normal effect).

3. **Steer** (second action): play a card or Push Through. The Steer never Resonates.
4. **End of turn**: do the end-of-turn steps (below).

Ways to play a card

- **Face up**: do its effect (and its Resonance if it Resonates). Tie 1 knot on its thread and move the Echo to that thread. Then: Obsession or Acceptance card → discard pile face up, or inscribe it in the Book if it Resonated and its slot is empty on the current Reach’s page (a Key Memory may be inscribed whenever played face up); Oblivion card → forgotten.
- **Face down**: place 1 Root and ignore the card’s text. No knot, the Echo stays. The card goes face up on the discard pile.
- **Burn** (at most once per turn): another player who holds a card of the same thread joins you. You each put a card of that thread face down, then flip both; you choose one and do its effect **twice**. Tie 1 knot on that thread and move the Echo there. Forget both cards; the other player draws 1 card. Nobody else has the thread → you cannot Burn. **Solo**: Burn one card: effect twice, 1 knot, move the Echo, then forget it and the top card of the deck.
- **Push Through** (once per game for each player): only if Shades hold both banks of the next space and it has no Black Water. Remove both Shades, move the soul there (gain its Light), flip your Push Through token. The soul takes 1 Fracture plus 1 for each Push Through token already face down, and you forget the top card of the deck.

Roots and Blooms

- **Place a Root**: a disc Root side up on an empty bank (no disc, no Shade) on the soul’s space or ahead. It must touch: the soul’s space or the next space, or the other bank of its space has a disc, or the same bank one space before or after has a disc.
- **Fog**: placing on a fog bank flips its bank card. **Fertile**: the Root stays. **Stony**: only with ”even on Stony ground” or the Root-Weaver, otherwise the Root is lost. **Memory Site**: the Root stays and you take a keepsake (Open Crossing: +2 Light). **Grave**: no Root; a Shade goes there.
- **Bloom**: flip a Root on the soul’s space or ahead to its Bloom side. A space with a Bloom is **Lit**; the soul only moves onto Lit spaces. **Wither**: flip a Bloom back to its Root side.

End of turn (after every player’s turn, in order)

1. **Bloom-Bringer**: if you hold it, Bloom 1 Root for free.
2. **Soul Step**:
   a. If the Resignation token is beside the soul: it does not move; forget the top card of the deck; remove the token. Go to *d*.
   b. Otherwise, if the next space is Lit and without Black Water: the soul moves there. Gain 1 Light per Bloom on the space it left, then clear that space (discs and Shades back to the supply). Entering a new Reach clears all knots from the Loom. Then check one **extra move**: with *9+* forgotten (Adrift) it moves one more space even if that space is dark or flooded, and takes 1 Fracture if it was (unless the Spirit Warden stops it); otherwise with *6+* forgotten (Light as Ash) it moves one more space only if that space is Lit and without Black Water.

c. Otherwise the soul cannot move: it **Lingers**. Nothing is forgotten if the Hold Fast token is out, the Spirit Warden is used, or the soul's own space is Lit (the Bride may step back once instead). Otherwise forget the top card of the deck.

d. Always, last: a Shade on either bank of the soul's space gives it 1 Fracture.

3. **Mist**: flip the top card of the current Reach's Mist deck and do it. Empty deck: shuffle that Reach's basic Mist cards.
4. **Cleanup**: Black Water with a disc on both banks of its space goes back in the box. A Shade with a Bloom on the same bank one space before and one after goes back to the supply.
5. **Draw** back up to 3 (4 in solo) (empty deck: shuffle the discard pile).
6. **Solo**: flip a Ghost card and do it; tie its knot and move the Echo; Cleanup again.
7. **Pass the Oar** left. Next turn: remove the Hold Fast token; the Spirit Warden straightens at its holder's turn; an unused Shield goes at the end of its owner's next turn.

The Loom (a thread is full at 4 (2–3 players) or 5 (solo, 4 players) knots)

A full thread causes its Backlash at once, then all its knots come off:

- **Obsession, Grasping**: a Shade on the soul's space (left bank, else right; both taken: the next space).
- **Acceptance, Resignation**: the Resignation token beside the soul (next Soul Step it stays and forgets 1).
- **Oblivion, the Tide Rises**: Black Water on the next space.

Threats

- **Black Water**: taken from the Ledger's well. If the space already has some, use the next space ahead without it. Blooms on that space wither. The soul cannot enter it. Removed Black Water goes in the box.
- **Shades**: on the bank named; taken: the other bank; both taken: the next space. A disc there goes back to the supply. No Root on a Shade's bank.
- **Fractures**: each on the next Ledger well; 3rd = Shattered. The Shield token cancels the next one.
- **Forgetting**: forgotten cards go face up on the Ledger's track. 6: Light as Ash · 9: Adrift · 8–11: Faded (you lose).

Light and Mantles

Gain 1 Light per Bloom on each space the soul leaves. Spend 3 to Recall (as your Answer) or to summon a Mantle.

- **The Root-Weaver** (Obsession): Your Roots may grow on Stony ground. Your first Root effect each turn places 1 extra Root.
- **The Spirit Warden** (Obsession): Once per round, stop the soul from Lingering or from drifting Adrift.
- **The Bloom-Bringer** (Acceptance): At the end of each of your turns, Bloom 1 Root for free.
- **The Fog-Breaker** (Oblivion): Your first Oblivion card each turn is discarded instead of forgotten.

The Book of Remembrance

- Each pair of neighbouring slots on a page gives its reward once, when the second of the two is inscribed:
- Page I: Place + Person: Place 1 Root. · Person + Deed: Bloom 1 Root. · Deed + Feeling: Gain 2 Light.
- Page II: Place + Person: Banish the nearest Shade. · Person + Deed: Drain the nearest Black Water. · Deed + Feeling: Untie 1 knot on the fullest thread (if tied, you choose).
- Page III: Place + Person: Return the newest forgotten card to the discard pile. · Person + Deed: Mend 1 Fracture. · Deed + Feeling: The soul steps forward now, if the next space is Lit.

- A full page (4 cards; the Garland Girl 3) also gives a **Chapter Blessing**: remove 1 Fracture; if none, remove the nearest Black Water ahead; if none, return the newest forgotten card to the discard pile.

Card words

- **Banish** a Shade / **Wash away** Shades: return them to the supply. **Drain** Black Water: remove it to the box.
- **Mend**: remove a Fracture. **Untie** / **Empty** the fullest thread: remove its knots, no Backlash (tied: you choose). **Tie**: add knots (full → Backlash).
- **Forget**: put the card face up on the Ledger's track. **Linger**: the soul does not move. **Lift the fog**: flip a Reach's bank cards without placing Roots; Graves turn Fertile.

The ending

When the game ends, check the Soul's Key Memory: inscribed, forgotten or never played. Then read the Book aloud, page by page; an empty slot reads "...but this, the river has taken".

Notes